

24.6 Summary and Notes

24.6.1 Summary

Idea.

1. Under classical, nondifferential error, least squares estimates the best linear predictor from the *reading*. A simple-regression slope is attenuated by the reliability λ , whatever n (Theorem 24.1.1).
2. Exactly measured covariates absorb part of the effect and can look important when they are not (Example (Age looks important)). Error in the response only adds variance (Proposition 24.1.2). The test of no effect of the mismeasured regressor keeps its level; tests on correlated, correctly measured covariates do not (Proposition 24.1.3).
3. Attenuation is the same with fixed true values (Proposition 24.2.1). The normal structural model identifies the slope only up to the interval between the direct and reverse regressions (Proposition 24.2.2). Berkson error causes no bias in a linear model (Proposition 24.2.3).
4. A known or replicate-estimated error covariance gives the moment correction, with a sandwich covariance (Theorem 24.3.1); a known variance ratio gives Deming regression (Proposition 24.3.2).
5. IV and two-stage least squares are consistent under exogeneity and relevance (Lemma 24.4.1, Theorem 24.4.2); with weak instruments they have no mean, drift towards least squares, and Wald intervals undercover (Proposition 24.4.3).
6. Linear regression calibration is exact and equals the moment correction (Proposition 24.5.1). SIMEX extrapolates the naive estimate to zero error; in the linear model the rational form matches the limit exactly, so the rational extrapolant is consistent under regularity conditions for its fit (Proposition 24.5.2).

24.6.2 Notes and sources

Sources. None of the six source books treats errors in variables at length. Seber and Lee (2003, section 9.6) surveys random regressors, fixed regressors measured with error, the structural identification problem, rounding errors and Berkson's model, covered here in Theorem 24.1.1, Proposition 24.2.1, Proposition 24.2.2, Exercise (C1) and Proposition 24.2.3. Fuller (1987) is the classical treatment of linear measurement error models, including moment estimators, their asymptotics and small-sample modifications. Carroll, Ruppert, Stefanski and Crainiceanu (2006) is the standard reference for nonlinear models, regression calibration and SIMEX, and discusses the choice of SIMEX extrapolant. All data in the chapter are simulated.

Attenuation and identification. Spearman (1904) introduced the correction for attenuation in mental testing. Reiersol (1950) proved that nonnormality of the true regressor restores identification. The functional model's incidental parameters are an instance of Neyman and Scott (1948). Gleser and Hwang (1987) proved that errors-in-variables confidence sets with guaranteed coverage have infinite expected length. Berkson (1950) distinguished controlled regressors from classical error.

Orthogonal and Deming regression. Orthogonal regression goes back to Adcock in the 1870s; the version with a known variance ratio carries Deming's name from Deming (1943). In

numerical analysis it is total least squares (Golub and Van Loan, 1980). Wald (1940) proposed the grouping estimator of Exercise (B1).

Instrumental variables. Instrumental variables go back to Wright (1928). Two-stage least squares was developed in the 1950s by Theil and by Basmann (1957), among others, and Sargan (1958) gave the general theory, including the test of overidentifying restrictions. Anderson and Rubin (1949) introduced the test of Exercise (C1). Bound, Jaeger and Baker (1995) showed the practical danger of weak instruments, and Staiger and Stock (1997) gave the asymptotics behind the first-stage F rule of thumb. Angrist and Pischke (2009) give a modern treatment, including the causal use of IV taken up in [Chapter 25](#).

Regression calibration and SIMEX. Regression calibration developed in epidemiology in the 1980s to correct relative risks for exposure measurement error. SIMEX is due to Cook and Stefanski (1994).

24.6.3 References

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